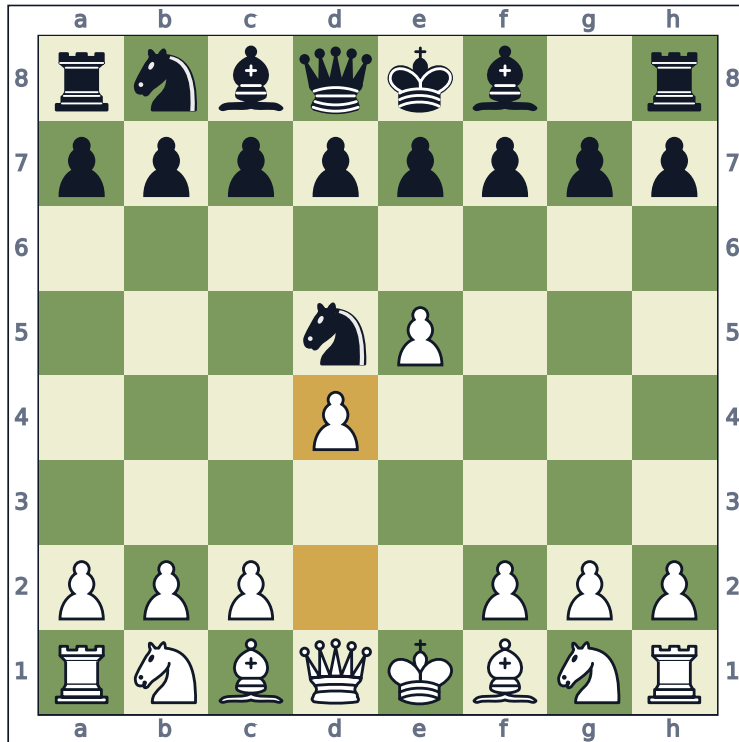


SEMI-OPEN AND UNCOMMON REPLIES TO 1.E4

Alekhine Defense

ECO B03 | 18 named lines in this code



Featured opening position - gold marks the last move

IS IT A GOOD OPENING?

Playable, but White has a meaningful objective edge. Black needs accurate counterplay.

ENGINE SNAPSHOT

+0.85 for White. A shallow opening score is a guide, not a forced result.

GAME CHARACTER

Principled and instructive: development and central breaks lead naturally into the middlegame.

WHAT THIS OPENING IS

B03 covers Alekhine Defense. White claims central space while Black chooses a less common route to challenge it. The diagram uses the featured line Alekhine Defense.

DEFINING ROUTE

1. e4 Nf6 2. e5 Nd5 3. d4

UNDERSTAND THE POSITION

What both sides are trying to achieve

WHITE'S GOALS

Occupy the center, develop with tempo when possible, and convert Black's unusual move order into a lead in activity.

BLACK'S GOALS

Attack the center rather than its edges, complete development, and prove the unusual setup has a concrete purpose.

PAWN BREAKS - THE ENGINE OF THE OPENING

White often uses d4 or e5; Black needs a reliable ...d5, ...e5, or ...c5 challenge.

PIECE MAP

Central knights and active bishops matter more than early pawn hunting. The central pawn placement should decide where each bishop and knight belongs.

WHAT USUALLY GOES WRONG

Do not assume an uncommon defense is bad. Refute moves with development and calculation, not impatience. Recheck the center after every opponent deviation; opening names do not make moves automatic.

POSITION SNAPSHOT

Black moves next. Material is level. Central markers: White pawn on d4, White pawn on e5.

WHO SHOULD STUDY IT?

Useful as surprise territory, though beginners should compare each line with a sound main defense.

COMPLETE CODE CONTENTS

Every named B03 line

This section preserves all 18 names and defining routes assigned to B03 in the source catalogue. Different move orders can reach the same position; learn the structures and goals before memorizing labels.

001 **Alekhine Defense**
1. e4 Nf6 2. e5 Nd5 3. d4

002 **Alekhine Defense**
1. e4 Nf6 2. e5 Nd5 3. d4 d6

003 **Alekhine Defense**
1. e4 Nf6 2. e5 Nd5 3. d4 d6 4. c4

004 **Alekhine Defense: Balogh Variation**
1. e4 Nf6 2. e5 Nd5 3. d4 d6 4. Bc4

005 **Alekhine Defense: Exchange Variation**
1. e4 Nf6 2. e5 Nd5 3. d4 d6 4. c4 Nb6 5. exd6

006 **Alekhine Defense: Exchange Variation, Karpov Variation**
1. e4 Nf6 2. e5 Nd5 3. d4 d6 4. c4 Nb6 5. exd6 cxd6 6. Nc3 g6 7. h3 Bg7 8. Nf3 O-O 9. Be2 Nc6 10. O-O Bf5 11. Bf4

007 **Alekhine Defense: Exchange Variation, Voronezh Variation**
1. e4 Nf6 2. e5 Nd5 3. d4 d6 4. c4 Nb6 5. exd6 cxd6 6. Nc3 g6 7. Be3 Bg7 8. Rc1 O-O 9. b3

008 **Alekhine Defense: Four Pawns Attack**
1. e4 Nf6 2. e5 Nd5 3. d4 d6 4. c4 Nb6 5. f4

009 **Alekhine Defense: Four Pawns Attack, Cambridge Gambit**
1. e4 Nf6 2. e5 Nd5 3. d4 d6 4. c4 Nb6 5. f4 g5

COMPLETE CODE CONTENTS

Every named B03 line

This section preserves all 18 names and defining routes assigned to B03 in the source catalogue. Different move orders can reach the same position; learn the structures and goals before memorizing labels.

010 Alekhine Defense: Four Pawns Attack, Fianchetto Variation

1. e4 Nf6 2. e5 Nd5 3. d4 d6 4. c4 Nb6 5. f4 g6

011 Alekhine Defense: Four Pawns Attack, Ilyin-Zhenevsky Variation

1. e4 Nf6 2. e5 Nd5 3. d4 d6 4. c4 Nb6 5. f4 dxe5 6. fxe5 Nc6 7. Nf3 Bg4 8. e6 fxe6 9. c5

012 Alekhine Defense: Four Pawns Attack, Korchnoi Variation

1. e4 Nf6 2. e5 Nd5 3. d4 d6 4. c4 Nb6 5. f4 dxe5 6. fxe5 Bf5 7. Nc3 e6 8. Nf3 Be7 9. Be2 O-O 10. O-O f6

013 Alekhine Defense: Four Pawns Attack, Main Line

1. e4 Nf6 2. e5 Nd5 3. d4 d6 4. c4 Nb6 5. f4 dxe5 6. fxe5 Nc6 7. Be3

014 Alekhine Defense: Four Pawns Attack, Tartakower Variation

1. e4 Nf6 2. e5 Nd5 3. d4 d6 4. c4 Nb6 5. f4 dxe5 6. fxe5 Nc6 7. Be3 Bf5 8. Nc3 e6 9. Nf3 Qd7 10. Be2 O-O-O 11. O-O Be7

015 Alekhine Defense: Four Pawns Attack, Trifunovic Variation

1. e4 Nf6 2. e5 Nd5 3. d4 d6 4. c4 Nb6 5. f4 Bf5

016 Alekhine Defense: Hunt Variation

1. e4 Nf6 2. e5 Nd5 3. d4 d6 4. c4 Nb6 5. c5

017 Alekhine Defense: Modern Variation, Alekhine Gambit

1. e4 Nf6 2. e5 Nd5 3. d4 d6 4. c4 Nb6 5. Nf3 Bg4 6. Be2

018 Alekhine Defense: O'Sullivan Gambit

1. e4 Nf6 2. e5 Nd5 3. d4 b5